

enduring beauty of the art and from a realization of the validity and permanence of the fundamental values that art represents. The collector takes pleasure in the beauty of art, and he never really ceases to be stimulated by it.

The 16th Century Italian poet Federico da Porto admitted he was "stupefied and overwhelmed" by what he saw when he visited the magnificent collection of the Venetian statesman-historian Marino Sanudo. Da Porto's poem marking the visit indicates that collectors of the 1500s were no different from those of today—and that he, himself, was infected by the sense of exhilaration and gratification that Sanudo obviously possessed in no less measure than do his modern-day collector counterparts. Wrote Da Porto:

*Then u p the stairs you lead us,
and we find A spacious corridor
before us spread, As i f it were
another ocean full O f rarest
things; the wall invisible
With glorious pictures hid—no blank
appears,
But various figures, men o f every guise;
A thousand unaccustomed scenes we see.
Here Spain, there Greece, and here the
apparel fair
O f France.*